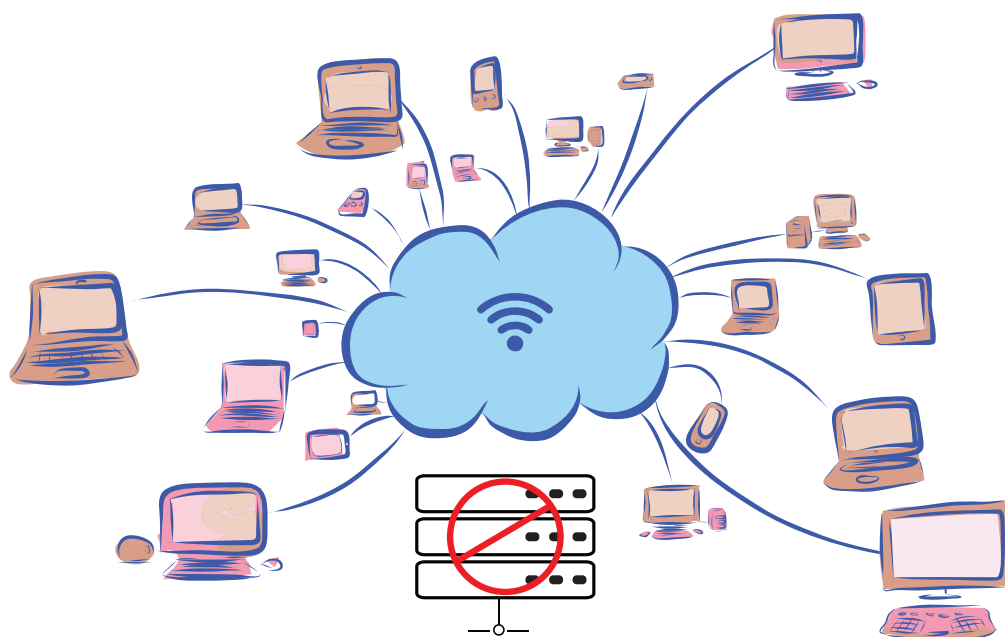


Should Businesses Opt for Serverless Computing?

Serverless computing removes the server from the equation and enables businesses to give undivided attention to the application functionality. Does that make serverless computing the automatic choice? Let's find out.



Until recently, almost every product manager organised his or her engineering resources into two separate teams — the development team and the operations team. The development team is usually involved in coding, testing and building the application functionality, whereas the operations team takes the responsibility of delivery, deployment, and operational maintenance of the application.

When a development team builds an e-commerce application, the operations team sets up the server to host that application. Setting up a server involves several aspects, which include:

- Applying the required set of patches
- Installing applicable server environments like JDK, Python, Tomcat, NodeJS, etc
- Deploying, configuring, and provisioning the actual application
- Opening and securing appropriate ports
- Setting up required database engines ... and the list just goes on.

Besides this, managers also break their heads on capacity planning. After all, any non-trivial application is expected to be 100 per cent available, reliable and scalable all the time. This requires optimal investment in the hardware. As we all know, shortage of hardware at crucial periods results in business loss, and on the other hand,

redundant hardware hurts the bottomline. Capacity planning is crucial, irrespective of whether the application is targeted for the on-premises data centre or for cloud infrastructure.

By now, it is clear that businesses spend a lot of time not only in building the functionality but also in delivering it.

Serverless computing aims at offering a seamless way to deliver the functionality without worrying about the server setup and maintenance. In other words, a serverless computing platform offers a ready-to-use environment in such a way that the businesses build and deploy the applications as a set of smaller functions as quickly as possible. That is why this approach is referred to as Function as a Service (FaaS).